ORBICUT

Orbicut is a new tool from the manufacturers of Kirjes in Sweden. It is designed to be safe and efficient, with two HSS cutters inserted into a ball which project about 0.1mm. This small amount of projection makes the tool easy to control while producing thin shavings instead of dust. The small Orbicut has a 20mm diameter head with a 6mm shank. The large Orbicut has a 40mm head with a 11mm shaft. The Orbicut;

- Works fast and efficiently at a low speed (5000 max rpm)
- Stays sharp for a long time thanks to its two HSS cutters
- Is easy to control and produces a clean cut surface
- Can be used in many types of rotary tools (flexible drives, drills, etc.)

FROM £54.94

Contact: Classic Hand Tools
Tel: 01473 784983
Web: www.classichandtools.com

PYRAMEX EMERGE SAFETY GLASSES

FROM $6.50

Like most woodturners, we've tried bucket loads of safety glasses over the years, but none have ever come close to rivalling the comfort, quality and performance of Pyramex Emerge Safety Glasses. Available with non-magnified lenses as well as full magnified lenses.

Contact: Craft Supplies USA
Tel: (001) 800 551 8876
Web: www.woodturnerscatalog.com

TEST: PAD-O-VAC POWER SANDING TOOL – BY MARK BAKER

The Pad-O-Vac is a power-sanding device that is designed, with the aid of a switched-on vacuum extractor, to extract as much dust as possible while sanding your work. The device is in effect a sanding arbor, which has a hook face on it, held at the end of a tube and this tube is affixed to a corded drill. There is a drill drive extension connector section which is fitted into the drill. The Pad-O-Vac has a drive spindle in the tube that affixes into the drill drive accessory, held in the end of the drill.

The main tube-like body of the Pad-O-Vac fits over a standard 43mm Euro collar found on corded drills. I am not aware of any cordless drills yet on the market with this collar arrangement: check that the drill you intend to use has this Euro collar arrangement. The manufacturers say there needs to be a snug fit on the Euro collar and to only tighten the fit by use of a small bolt and nut arrangement, if really necessary.

Now for the clever bit: there is a side offshoot of the tube that allows you to fit a vacuum extraction unit hose to the Pad-O-Vac. The manufacturers state that not all extractor hoses are the same and that you may either need an adaptor or use tape to form a seal, allowing the vacuum nozzle to seat properly onto the Pad-O-Vac. Once the extractor tube is in place, apply a sanding disc, with loop backing, to the hook-faced sanding arbor, switch on your vacuum unit and sand your work.

The Pad-O-Vac is well constructed and sturdy. I found that the extraction off-chute when coupled to an extraction unit worked well at extracting dust, but not all of it. That said, it certainly made a big difference over normal power sanding. I would use this tool in conjunction with other at-source extraction. Using at-source extraction both with and without the Pad-O-Vac being linked to an extraction source, I could tell the difference the Pad-O-Vac made.

The Pad-O-Vac took a little getting used to, especially when manoeuvring the whole coupled-up system, but after a bit of practice I could do so easily. It became easier when the sanding arbor was presented slightly trailing to the work. Two important things to note is that interface pads cannot be used on the front of the sanding arbor with the unit. The extra length past the extraction tube adversely affects the suction of the dust. I also found Pad-O-Vac cannot sand tight-radius internal curves because the extraction tube shielding hits part of the curve.

£34.50

I found the unit very effective in working on external curves and shallow internal curves and worked well when operated in accordance with the instructions supplied.

Contact: Cobbs Tool Design
Tel: 01566 777 599
Web: www.pad-o-vac.co.uk

Conversion chart

2mm (5/64in)
3mm (1/8in)
4mm (5/32in)
6mm (1/4in)
7mm (9/32in)
8mm (5/16in)
9mm (11/32in)
10mm (3/8in)
11mm (7/16in)
12mm (1/2in)
13mm (1/2in)
14mm (9/16in)
15mm (9/16in)
16mm (5/8in)
17mm (11/16in)
18mm (23/32in)
19mm (3/4in)
20mm (3/4in)
21mm (13/16in)
22mm (7/8in)
23mm (29/32in)
24mm (15/16in)
25mm (1in)
30mm (1 1/8in)
32mm (1 1/4in)
35mm (1 3/8in)
38mm (1 1/2in)
40mm (1 5/8in)
45mm (1 3/4in)
50mm (2in)
55mm (2 1/8-2 1/4in)
60mm (2 3/8in)
63mm (2½in)
65mm (2 5/8in)
70mm (2 3/4in)
75mm (3in)
80mm (3 1/8in)
85mm (3 1/4in)
90mm (3 1/2in)
93mm (3 2/3in)
95mm (3 3/4in)
100mm (4in)
105mm (4 1/8in)
110mm (4 1/4-4 3/8in)
115mm (4½in)
120mm (4 3/4in)
125mm (5in)
130mm (5 1/8in)
135mm (5 1/4in)
140mm (5 1/2in)
145mm (5 3/4in)
150mm (6in)
155mm (6 1/8in)
160mm (6 1/4in)
165mm (6 1/2in)
170mm (6 3/4in)
178mm (6 7/8in)
180mm (7in)
185mm (7 1/4in)
190mm (7½in)
195mm (7 3/4in)
200mm (8in)
305mm (12in)
405mm (16in)
510mm (20in)
610mm (24in)
710mm (28in)
815mm (32in)
915mm (36in)
1015mm (40in)
1120mm (44in)
1220mm (48in)
1320mm (52in)
1420mm (56in)
1525mm (60in)

WT_291_94_97_KIT_&_TOOLS_vsMBbd.indd 97 24/02/2016 16:35